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UHLB2122
PROFESSIONAL COMMUNICATION SKILLS 1

SECTION 52

REPORT WRITING

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WEAK COMMUNICATION SKILLS AMONG UNIVERSITY STUDENTS

1.0 INTRODUCTION

Proficiency in communication is essential for university students' academic success, personal growth and future employment. However, many students still struggle to communicate effectively with others, express themselves clearly or speak in front of an audience. Whenever there is a presentation or oral sessions, student will be extremely nervous and unable to express themselves clearly. Studies show that many first-year students often feel anxious when speaking in front of their peers because of cultural barriers, low self-esteem or fear of being judged (Chishiba & Joseph, 2024). The lack of practical speaking opportunities in academic settings further worsens the issue. If those issues are left unaddressed, students may fail to develop their communication skills which is critical for their future. Therefore, this report studies the causes and consequences of university students' with poor communication skills. Plenty of solution are suggested to get out of those situation. Before outlining the two possible fixes, we will first look at the problem's underlying causes and effects.

2.0 BACKGROUND OF THE PROBLEM

2.1 Causes of the Problem

Public speaking anxiety is a major contributing factor to university students' weak communication skilld. Many students are afraid of making mistakes or receiving negative feedback which limits their participation in class and oral assessments (Suparlan, 2021). Students choose to avoid public speaking because of this anxiety, which is frequently caused by low self-esteem, lack of practice and worries about grammar or pronunciation fault. For example, students often feel anxious when preparing presentations because they worry about making mistakes or using language poorly, such as wrong understanding in projects or pronouncing words incorrectly, which could cause embarrassment (Wu, 2019). As a result, they tend to avoid speaking in public, losing out valuable opportunities to practise and improve their communication skills.

Cultural barriers also play a role because students from different cultures may accept norms that prohibit questioning official figures or self-expression. In some cultural contexts, silence is interpreted as a virtue which makes it difficult for learners who need to participate actively to engage in discussion-based classes (Moisei, 2024). As a result of these background

expectations, such students tend not to answer questions nor volunteer ideas into discussions resulting in loss of chances to enhance their communication skills.

Effects of the Problem

One major effect of weak communication skills is a decline in academic performance and classroom participation. Anxiety about public speaking causes students to shy away from conversations, enquiries, and presentations, which hinders their participation and learning. Over time, their confidence drops even further, making them less likely to volunteer for leadership roles or taking part in group projects(Suparlan, 2021). For instance, student will not volunteer answering lecturers' questions and might not be able to present their work in front of others effectively and fluently leading to receive lower marks for coursework's oral components

Another significant effect is reduced students employability and professional confidence. Graduates with poor communication skills often face challenges in job interviews, meetings and teamwork (Wu et al., 2023). In workplace, where open communication and teamwork are expected, cultural barriers that restrict expression in higher education may persist. Employers may view a student's leadership potential differently if they are a student who seldom speaks up during group projects and later finds it difficult to share ideas or take initiative in the workplace.

3.0 POSSIBLE SOLUTIONS

3.1 Solution 1: Conduct Smaller Group Session

Conducting a smaller tutorial or group sessions where students feel more comfortable expressing themselves than in large lecture halls are one of the effective way to address the poor communication skills and public speaking anxiety(Annamalai et al., 2015). This can be implemented by dividing large classes into smaller discussion groups or assigning weekly breakout sessions digitally for oral speaking practices or discussions. Students can practise speaking in a less frightening and safer environment with this method, which can greatly lower anxiety and progressively boost confidence. In a smaller class, students who are tend to be quiet in larger ones might feel more encouraged to share their opinions. However, one of the limitations of this method is that it requires more time, space and tutors which may not always be feasible for all classes especially with large number of students (Arja et al., 2020).

3.2 Solution 2: Use of the Digital Speaking Content

Another innovative approach is to motivate students to produce speaking content digitally, for instance, through video reflections and presentations or creative vlogs. Implementation can be done through assignments where students are required to share their thoughts or reflect on the lessons through video (Hasanah, 2019). This facilitates speaking practice as students can record their speeches in private, review them afterwards, and make improvements to each subsequent recording. It also augments digital literacy skills and confidence among learners. The downside is that some students may feel self-conscious in front of the camera while others may edit too much focusing on looks instead of actual spoken content.

4.0 THE BEST APPROACH

The integration of methods for sharpening communication skills among university students like having smaller group sessions and using digital speaking content, is both thorough and effective. The small group format eases the anxiety associated with public speaking by allowing live interaction within a more intimate setting, while digital recordings empower students to practice speech therapy at their convenience. Each method contains advantages and disadvantages, but they are all practical and attainable within the university context.

5.0 CONCLUSION

In conclusion, communication is a very important skill for academic, job, and personal success of students. This report highlighted the primary causes of ineffective communication were found to be fear of public speaking, lack of practice, and cultural variations which could impact students' academic success and readiness for work. Solutions like smaller group sessions and digital speaking tasks offer practical methods for building confidence among students. Universities should adopt these strategies to provide consistent opportunities for improvement. Students who improve their communication skills will be more equipped for the workforce and contribute to the development of a more self-assured and competent generation.

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